



DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL NEWTOWN
SESSION 2025-2026
FINAL EXAMINATION

CLASS: VIII
SUBJECT: ENGLISH PAPER I (SET A)

FULL MARKS: 80
TIME: 2 HOURS

Answers to this Paper must be written on the paper provided separately.

You will not be allowed to write during the first 10 minutes.

This time is to be spent in reading the question paper.

The time given at the head of this Paper is the time allowed for writing the answers.

Attempt all five questions.

The intended marks for questions or parts of questions are given in brackets [].

This paper consists of seven printed pages.

Question 1

Write a composition (300-350 words) on any one of the following:

[20]

- i) 'Technological evolution has made students lazy thinkers.' Express your views either for or against this statement.
- ii) Write an original short story that begins with the words: "*I was halfway through my coffee when my smartwatch pulsed sharply, the message appearing in bold red letters: Target Identified — anomaly detected.*"
- iii) You were on your way to doing an important work when you suddenly discovered that your wallet was missing. Describe an account of the panic that followed, the people you met and how the incident became a lesson in responsibility and compassion.
- iv) Narrate an incident when you had to take a major decision in a moment of pressure. Explain the confusion you faced, the factors that helped you decide and how the outcome affected your confidence.

v) Study the picture given below. Write a story or a description or an account of what it suggests to you. Your composition may be about the subject of the picture or you may take suggestions from it; however, there must be a clear connection between the picture and your composition.



Question 2

Select **any one** of the following:

[10]

- i) You tried your hand at cooking during the vacation and ended up with some amusing results!
Write a letter to your friend sharing your funny kitchen experiments, the lessons you learnt and your pride when your first successful dish turned out well.
- ii) The public park in your locality, once a place of recreation and relaxation, is now in a poor condition due to lack of maintenance. Write a letter to the Chairman of the Municipal Corporation drawing attention to the issue and requesting necessary action for its repair and upkeep.

Question 3

- i) The school is planning to conduct a Marathon to spread the importance of an active lifestyle. Write a notice for the school notice board for the Middle School students providing details regarding the event. [5]
- ii) Your school is organizing a Marathon under the theme '*Run for Fitness*' to promote the importance of an active lifestyle among students. As the Head of the Student Council, write an email to a famous sports personality inviting him/her to be the Chief Guest for the event. Mention the purpose of the event and how his/her presence would inspire the students. [5]

Question 4

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:

It was a quiet autumn afternoon when I returned to Green Hollow after nearly fifteen years. The path leading to the old house was lined with golden leaves that whispered softly beneath my feet. The house itself stood at the far end of the field, unchanged, yet strangely smaller than I had remembered. The once-white walls were now pale with age, and the creepers that my mother had planted had grown wild, embracing the walls like an affectionate but *untamed* memory.

As I pushed open the rusty gate, a rush of childhood moments flooded back — the laughter of summer evenings, the scent of freshly baked bread, and my father's gentle voice calling us in for supper. Every corner of the garden seemed to hold a story. The swing where my sister and I once quarrelled now hung lifeless, its ropes *frayed* by time. The mango tree, once our fortress of adventure, was heavy with age, its branches bending like an old man's back.

I found old Martha in the kitchen, still bustling about with the same briskness. Her face was a map of wrinkles, but her eyes were alive with warmth. "So you've come back, Master Edwin," she said, wiping her hands on her apron. "The house missed you."

Her words touched something deep within me. I had left this place as a restless youth, eager to conquer the world, blind to the quiet treasures of home. Now, returning with grey in my hair and silence in my heart, I realised how much I had lost in chasing distant dreams.

We sat by the fire as twilight deepened. The clock on the mantel ticked steadily — the same clock my father had wound each night with mechanical devotion. Martha poured me tea, and for a while, neither of us spoke. The room glowed with the orange light of the hearth, and shadows danced across the walls like ghosts of the past.

When I finally walked up to my old room, I found everything preserved — the books, the wooden desk, the faded curtains. On the windowsill lay a seashell I had once brought from the coast, a small token of my boyhood adventure. I held it in my hand, and for a brief moment, I was ten again — barefoot, sunburnt, and full of impossible dreams.

That night, as the wind whispered through the orchard, I knew this was my last visit to Green Hollow. The world beyond its fields no longer called to me with the same voice. I had returned not to stay, but to remember — and to say goodbye to the boy I once was.

i) For each word given below choose the correct meaning (as used in the passage) from the options provided: [2]

1. *untamed*

- a) indisciplined
- b) unrestrained
- c) cultivated
- d) subdued

2. *frayed*

- a) mended
- b) braided
- c) woven
- d) tattered

ii) Which word in the passage means the opposite of '*sluggishness*'? [1]

- a) restless
- b) bustling
- c) briskness
- d) deepened

iii) Answer the following questions briefly in your words:

- a) Describe the scene that greeted Edwin when he returned to Green Hollow. [2]
- b) What memories came back to him as he walked through the gate? [2]
- c) Why did the author leave the place ? What did he later realise when he revisited it? [2]
- d) Analyse Martha's character as per the given passage. Justify your answer with suitable references from the text. [2]
- e) What message about life and memory does the story convey? [1]

iv) In not more than 50 words describe the changes in the house and garden and their significance to Edwin. [8]

Question 5

i) Fill in each of the numbered blanks with the correct form of the word given in brackets.. Do not copy the passage but write in correct serial order the word or phrase appropriate to the blank: space. *Example: (0) was* [$\frac{1}{2} \times 8 = 4$]

It (0)____ (*be*) a bright Sunday morning when I (1)____ (*decide*) to visit the old museum in the town. I (2)____ (*hear*) about the museum for years, but I (3)____ (*never/visit*) it before. As I (4)____ (*walk*) through the entrance, I realised that many changes (5)____ (*take/place*) since my last visit ten years ago. The curator (6)____ (*organise*) several new exhibitions, and I (7)____ (*already/see*) a few of them online. By the time the guided tour (8)____ (*begin*), I had read all the information boards carefully.

ii) Fill in the blanks with suitable words:

[½x8=4]

- a) The responsibility for the failure was attributed ____ the negligence of the senior officer.
- b) The committee finally selected him since he was adept ____ leading a large team to complete projects within deadline.
- c) The toxic gas gradually dissolved ____ the atmosphere.
- d) I cannot do anything as it is ____ my capacity.
- e) He is renowned ____ his groundbreaking research in quantum physics.
- f) The negotiations broke down ____ a disagreement over territorial rights.
- g) She is proficient ____ five different programming languages.
- h) The city was inundated ____ torrential rains that lasted for three days.

iii) Change the degree of the following sentences according to the instructions given after each.
Choose the correct options.

[4]

1) No other athlete is as hardworking as Serena. (*End with: athlete.*)

- a) Serena is the most hardworking athlete.
- b) Serena is more hardworking than any athlete.
- c) Serena is one of the most hardworking athletes.
- d) Serena is a hardworking athlete.

2) This smartphone is the most advanced in the market. (*Use: 'more advanced'*)

- a) This smartphone is more advanced than most other smartphones.
- b) No other smartphone is more advanced than this.
- c) This smartphone is more advanced than any other smartphone in the market.
- d) This smartphone is more advanced than all phones.

3) Very few cities are as picturesque as Venice. (*Change the degree*)

- a) Venice is one of the most picturesque cities.
- b) No other city is as picturesque as Venice.
- c) Venice is more picturesque than most cities.
- d) Venice is the most picturesque city.

4) K2 is one of the steepest mountains. (*End with: as K2.*)

- a) No other mountain is as steep as K2.
- b) Very few mountains are as steep as K2.
- c) One of the steepest mountains is known as K2.
- d) This mountain is as steep as K2 mountain.

iv) Rewrite the following sentences according to the instructions given after each. Make other changes but do not change the meaning of each sentence. Choose the correct options. [8]

1) He forgot to lock the door. The house was burgled. (*Join the following sentences to make one complete sentence without using and, but or so.*)

- a) Since he forgot to lock the door, the house was burgled.
- b) Having forgotten to lock the door, the house was burgled.
- c) Because he forgot to lock the door, the house was burgled.
- d) As he forgot to lock the door, the house was burgled.

2) The scientist invented a new device. It could detect earthquakes early. (*Join into a complex sentence*)

- a) The scientist invented a new device that could detect earthquakes early.
- b) The scientist who invented a new device could detect earthquakes early.
- c) The scientist invented a new device and it could detect earthquakes early.
- d) Both a and b

3) She was tired. She continued working. (*Join the following sentences to make one complete sentence without using and, but or so.*)

- a) She was tired although she continued working.
- b) She continued working yet she was tired.
- c) Though she was tired, she continued working.
- d) She was tired as she continued working.

4) I am saving money because I want to buy a new bicycle. (*Join into a simple sentence*)

- a) I am saving money so that I want to buy a new bicycle.
- b) I want to buy a new bicycle, so I am saving money.
- c) I am saving money for I want to buy a new bicycle.
- d) I am saving money to buy a new bicycle.

5) I don't know where she has gone. (*Identify the correct clause*)

- a) I don't know where she has gone. (Noun Clause)
- b) I don't know where she has gone. (Adjective Clause)
- c) I don't know where she has gone. (Adverb Clause)
- d) I don't know where she has gone. (Noun Clause)

6) He finished his homework. His friends were waiting for him. (*Join the two sentences using an adverb clause*)

- a) Although his friends were waiting for him, he finished his homework.
- b) He finished his homework while his friends were waiting for him.
- c) Because his friends were waiting for him, he finished his homework.
- d) Both a and b

7) The book that I borrowed from the library is interesting. (*Identify the correct clause*)

- a) The book that I borrowed from the library is interesting. (Noun Clause)
- b) The book that I borrowed from the library is interesting. (Adjective Clause)
- c) The book that I borrowed from the library is interesting. (Adverb Clause)
- d) The book that I borrowed from the library is interesting. (Adjective Clause)

8) I wanted to go for a walk. It started raining. (*Join into a compound sentence*)

- a) I wanted to go for a walk when it started raining.
- b) It started raining but I wanted to go for a walk.
- c) I wanted to go for a walk but it started raining.
- d) I wanted to go for a walk as it was raining.